

GIVE AND TAKE
The iconic Open Hand monument in Chandigarh

MONEY SHARMA/GETTY IMAGES

THE NATION | CHANDIGARH

CAPITAL CONFLICT

Union home minister Amit Shah lit the spark, and Punjab and Haryana renewed their battle over Chandigarh

By Anilesh S. Mahajan

Days after the Punjab assembly passed a resolution reiterating the state's claim on Chandigarh, legislators from Haryana convened a special session of their Vidhan Sabha on April 5 to stake a counter claim. The two northern states have a long-standing dispute over the ownership of their joint capital, along with residual issues from the 1966 Punjab Reorganisation Act that carved out modern-day Punjab and Haryana. The latest round of hostilities was triggered after Union home minister Amit Shah, on a visit to Chandigarh on March 27, announced that Central Civil Services rules will apply on employees of the Union territory (UT), instead of Punjab Civil Services Rules, from April 1.

This has angered most political parties in Punjab who see it as "another big blow to the rights of Punjab". The Sukhbir Badal-led